

Crunchwell — FY27–FY29 Turnaround Plan

Rebuilding relevance for the flagship — a three-year strategic commitment

Document type Strategic commitment (3-year)
Period FY27–FY29
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The problem	Relevance, not Trust — Relevance 68.6→62.7 (–5.9pp, 6 waves)
Trust	Holds ~72 (72.3→72.9) — the franchise is not broken
National share	6.0% flat, slipping at the edges
Louisiana battlefield	6.4% → 3.0% (–340 bps)
3-year commitment	Arrest decline FY27, return to growth FY28–FY29 (targets)

Executive summary

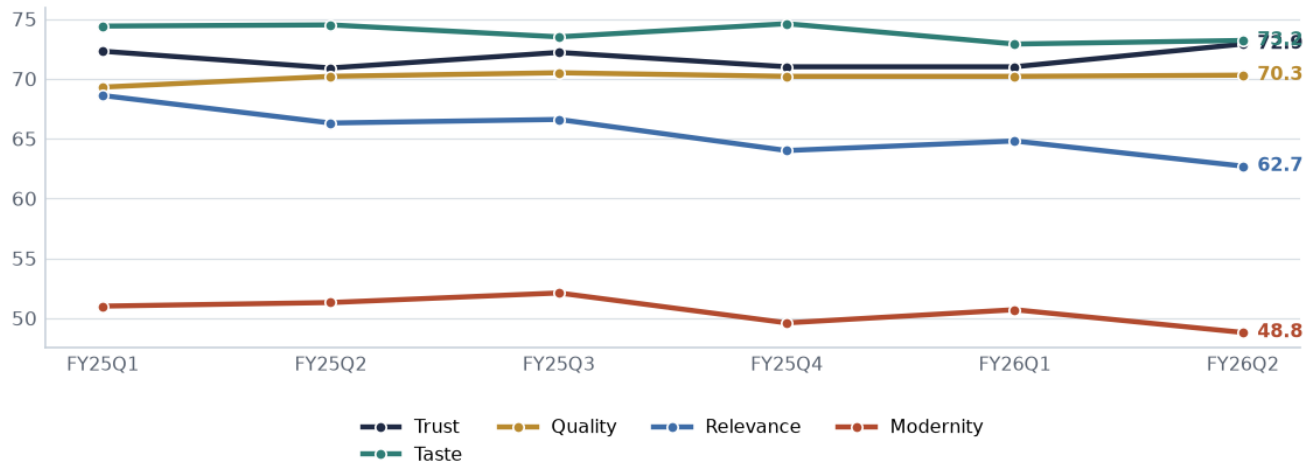
Crunchwell is Acme's flagship and its diagnosis is precise: this is a relevance problem, not a trust problem. Over six quarters, brand Relevance fell 5.9 points (68.6 → 62.7) while Trust held steady at ~72 and Taste and Quality barely moved. The brand is still trusted; it is drifting out of cultural relevance. National value share is flat at 6.0% but slipping at the edges — Louisiana has collapsed –340 bps (6.4% → 3.0%), leading-indicator DMAs Birmingham and Memphis are softening, and the price gap to Field & Honey has widened from 8% to 14%. This plan is a three-year commitment built on four pillars — rebuild relevance, restore an innovation cadence, close the price gap through RGM, and recover Louisiana and the leading indicators — with a phased goal: arrest the share decline in FY27, then return to growth in FY28–FY29 (planning targets).

- **Relevance, not Trust.** Relevance 68.6 → 62.7 (–5.9pp over 6 waves); Trust 72.3 → 72.9 (holds); Taste and Quality flat (brand_equity_quarterly). The equity signal is unambiguous.
- **Share is flat nationally, failing regionally.** National ~6.0% flat; Louisiana –340 bps (6.4→3.0); Birmingham 5.7→5.4 and Memphis 5.4→5.1 softening (early LA pattern).
- **Price gap widening.** The gap to Field & Honey has moved from ~8% to ~14% — a real RGM problem behind the relevance one.
- **Social sentiment is negative.** Crunchwell reads –0.11 on 316 mentions in 2026 — the relevance gap made visible in culture.
- **The commitment:** four pillars, three years — arrest the decline in FY27, return to growth in FY28–FY29 (planning targets).

1 · The diagnosis — relevance, not trust

RELEVANCE	TRUST	NATIONAL SHARE	SOCIAL SENTIMENT
62.7	72.9	6.0%	–0.11
–5.9pp over 6 waves	holds (was 72.3)	flat, edges slipping	316 mentions, 2026

The single most important slide in this plan is the equity trend. Kantar tracks five attributes for Crunchwell; over six quarters (FY25Q1 → FY26Q2), four are essentially flat and one is falling. Relevance — Cory's lead-indicator attribute — dropped 5.9 points, from 68.6 to 62.7. Trust rose slightly (72.3 → 72.9). Taste (74.4 → 73.2) and Quality (69.3 → 70.3) held; Modernity is soft (51.0 → 48.8) and moves with Relevance. The read is decisive: consumers still trust Crunchwell and still rate its taste, but it is fading from their consideration set. You do not fix a relevance problem with a trust message — you fix it with modern positioning, cultural presence, and a reason to re-consider.

Crunchwell brand equity — Top-2-box % by attribute (6 waves)

Trust, Taste and Quality hold; Relevance falls 5.9pp and Modernity softens. *brand_equity_quarterly* (Kantar Brand Equity Tracker, US-NAT).

Source: *brand_equity_quarterly* (Kantar), Crunchwell US-NAT, FY25Q1–FY26Q2; *social_mentions* (2026, Crunchwell –0.11 on 316 mentions).

Why this reframes the whole plan

If the problem were Trust, the answer would be reassurance and heritage. Because the problem is Relevance, the answer is modern positioning, creators and social presence, and an innovation cadence that gives shoppers a reason to look again. Every pillar below flows from this one diagnosis.

2 · National flat, but the edges are slipping

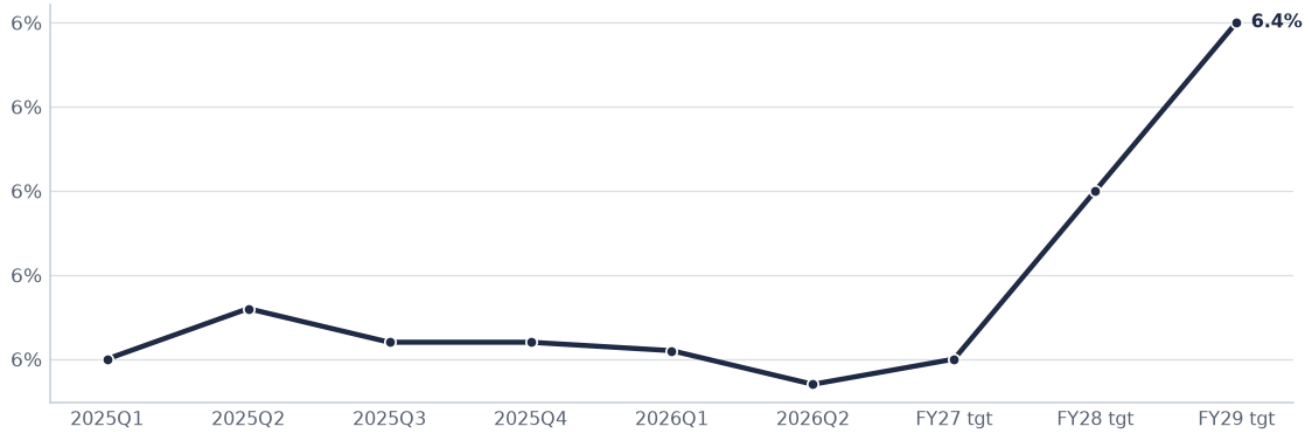
The national number reassures and misleads. Crunchwell's national value share has held at ~6.0% for six quarters (6.00 in 2025Q1, 5.97 in 2026Q2). But share is being lost at the geographic edges, and the pattern is spreading. Louisiana is the acute case — a -340 bps collapse from 6.4% to 3.0% (New Orleans 5.1→3.0, Baton Rouge 5.8→4.2). More concerning strategically, the two leading-indicator DMAs Acme flagged — Birmingham (5.7→5.4) and Memphis (5.4→5.1) — are now showing the early LA pattern: Field & Honey endcap presence up, Crunchwell Mega velocity softening. A flat national average is what a slow regional bleed looks like before it reaches the headline.

2.1 · Battlefields and leading indicators — Crunchwell share (FY25 → Q1 FY26)

Geography	FY25	Q1 FY26	Δ	Tier
Louisiana DMA	6.4%	3.0%	-340 bps	Battlefield
New Orleans-Metairie MSA	5.1%	3.0%	-210 bps	Battlefield
Baton Rouge MSA	5.8%	4.2%	-160 bps	Battlefield
Birmingham-Tuscaloosa-Anniston DMA	5.7%	5.4%	-30 bps	Leading-indicator watch
Memphis DMA	5.4%	5.1%	-30 bps	Leading-indicator watch

Source: seeds/geographies.csv (Crunchwell share by geography). Canonical LA headline 6.4%→3.0% / -340 bps (docs/louisiana-decline.md).

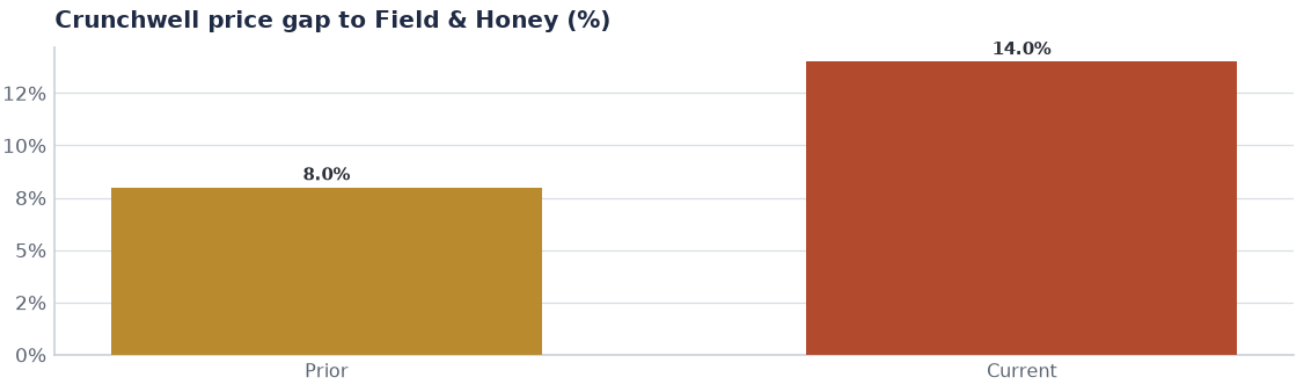
Crunchwell national value share — actual & FY27-FY29 targets (%)



History is flat at ~6.0% (syndicated_weekly, ex-LA). The FY27–FY29 points are planning targets: arrest in FY27, growth FY28–FY29.

2.2 · The price gap is widening

Underneath the relevance problem is a real revenue-growth-management one. The price gap between Crunchwell and Field & Honey has widened from roughly 8% to 14% as Larksfield holds sharper everyday and promoted prices. A widening gap makes every relevance and innovation dollar work harder than it should; closing it is Pillar 3.



The gap has widened ~6 points. Price-gap figures per the FY27 plan grounding (Reports 18 / 39).

3 · The four-pillar turnaround plan

Four pillars, sequenced so relevance and innovation lead, RGM funds, and the regional recovery proves the model in-market. All revenue outcomes are FY27–FY29 planning targets.

Pillar 1 · Rebuild relevance and brand

The lead pillar attacks the diagnosis directly: modern positioning, a creator and social program, and a shift of message away from heritage-trust toward cultural relevance. Crunchwell's 2026 social sentiment is –0.11 across 316 mentions — the relevance gap made visible. The mandate is to move that number positive and to arrest the Relevance decline, then reverse it, over the three years. This is where the plan's center of gravity sits.

Pillar 2 · Restore an innovation cadence

Initiative	Stage	Planned	Yr-1 (est.)	Conf.
Pack Refresh - Hero SKUs	S5 Launch Prep	2026-08-15	\$28.0M	0.82
Hispanic Format - Maiz Crunch	S2 Concept	2027-Q1	\$12.0M	0.46
Mega Family Pack 36oz	S3 Prototype	2027-Q1	\$8.5M	0.62
Cinnamon Twist - Reformulation	S3 Prototype	2026-Q4	Recovery	0.52

Source: seeds/innovation_pipeline.csv (Crunchwell). Yr-1 revenue = planning estimate.

The cadence is anchored by the **Pack Refresh — Hero SKUs** (Stage-5 Launch Prep, \$28M year-1 planning estimate, confidence 0.82, launching 2026-08-15) — the biggest near-term bet and the visible signal that Crunchwell is modernizing. Behind it: **Hispanic 'Maiz Crunch'** (\$12M, Stage-2, target 2027-Q1) to recruit a growing shopper base, **Mega Family Pack 36oz** (\$8.5M, Stage-3, target 2027-Q1) for value/pantry-load, and the **Cinnamon Twist reformulation** (Stage-3, 2026-Q4) to fix a known underperformer. See the innovation portfolio, Report 33.

Pillar 3 · RGM — close the price gap

Pillar 3 funds the plan and removes the RGM drag. Close the price gap to Field & Honey (from ~14% back toward ~8%) through architecture and pack-price-architecture work, not blunt promotion — Crunchwell already carries a heavy ~25.6%-of-gross trade rate at low incrementality. The goal is a healthier price-pack ladder that improves realized price while narrowing the shelf gap that hands Larksfield an everyday-value story.

Pillar 4 · Louisiana + leading-indicator recovery

Pillar 4 proves the model in-market. Louisiana (–340 bps) has a funded recovery plan — facing recovery, targeted trade, and a LA retail-media injection at ~2.2x portfolio ROI — and the Pack Refresh (Leg 3) is tied to it. Extend the same playbook pre-emptively to the leading-indicator DMAs Birmingham and Memphis before they follow Louisiana's path; Tasha's Q3 Walmart Connect reroute already targets these markets. See the Louisiana diagnostic, Report 17.

4 · The three-year commitment

The commitment is phased and explicit. FY27 is about arresting the decline — stabilizing Relevance and national share and closing the acute Louisiana gap. FY28–FY29 return the flagship to growth. **All FY27–FY29 outcomes are planning targets, not forecasts.**

Horizon	Commitment	Lead metric	Target (planning)
FY27	Arrest the decline	Relevance / national share	Relevance stops falling; share holds ~6.0%
FY27	Close the acute gap	Louisiana share	Recover LA off the 3.0% trough
FY28	Return to growth	National share	Share up to ~6.2% (target)
FY29	Compound the recovery	National share / Relevance	Share ~6.4%; Relevance rebuilding (target)

Source: Planning targets set against brand_equity_quarterly and syndicated_weekly baselines. FY27–FY29 figures are commitments/targets, not measured or forecast history.

Risks to the commitment

(1) Relevance is a slow-moving metric — a positioning reset takes several waves to read, so FY27 progress may look like stabilization before improvement. (2) Field & Honey keeps escalating (Family Sweet stealth, 14g protein, likely Q4 chocolate) on both the price and innovation fronts. (3) The Pack Refresh (2026-08-15) is the biggest single bet — execution risk on it is execution risk on the whole FY27 arrest. (4) The heavy trade rate must come down as RGM works, or Pillar 3 self-funds too slowly.

Recommendations & next steps

#	Action	Owner	When
1	Stand up the Pillar 1 relevance program — modern positioning + creator/social — and set a quarterly Relevance and sentiment tracker as the lead KPI.	Cory Whitman / VP Marketing	FY27 H1
2	Land the Pack Refresh (2026-08-15) as the visible modernization signal; protect the launch.	Cory Whitman / Audrey Kim	Aug 2026
3	Sequence Maiz Crunch, Mega 36oz and the Cinnamon Twist reformulation to sustain the FY27–FY28 innovation cadence.	Lillian Park	FY27–FY28
4	Run the RGM price-pack-architecture work to close the Field & Honey gap from ~14% toward ~8% without deepening trade.	RGM / Finance	FY27
5	Execute the Louisiana recovery and extend the playbook to Birmingham/Memphis before they follow (see Report 17).	Marcus Boudreaux / Tasha Brooks	FY27 H1